MEET the grain



Couscous

Couscous (pronounced Koose-Koose) is considered a pasta which is made of small granules of semolina flour. Unlike pasta, it is made from crushed duram wheat semolina while pasta is made from ground wheat. It is also available made from whole-wheat flour, which slightly increases the fiber and boosts nutritional value It is a culinary ingredient, originating from North Africa and is used as a substitution for rice or quinoa. It is very versatile, and its preparation requires little more than the addition of hot water and fluffing with a fork. Ways to serve Couscous include adding it to soups, mixing it with sautéed vegetables, and as a breakfast cereal; taking on the flavor of whatever you cook it with.

1 cup serving of couscous provides only 176 calories, or 8% of a standard 2,000 calorie diet.

It adds 6g of protein to your day, or 12% of the daily intake recommended by the Food and Drug Administration. Other grains typically provide a lower levels of this macro-nutrient, which is needed for muscle building after exercise, and sustaining energy. A perfect fit for today's health–conscious eaters.

Carbohydrates make up the majority of the calories in whole wheat couscous, totaling 38g per 1 cup serving whole grain couscous contains more fat than white flour couscous, but the totals are still quite small. A 1 cup serving of the whole wheat variety contains only 1g.

Including couscous in your diet provides several health benefits. A 1 cup serving of couscous provides 43 mcg of selenium, or 61% of the 70 mcg daily value. This is a trace mineral that the body needs in small quantities, acting as an antioxidant and protecting healthy cells from the mutating effects of toxins that change the DNA and structural composition, leading to disease and premature aging.

The potassium in couscous provides important functions, such as regulating blood pressure and the heartbeat. Potassium helps control fluid balance, an important factor in blood pressure regulation.

Couscous has 3.6 g of protein for every 100 grams and contains a 1% fat to calorie ratio.

